







1. *A camel herder from the Banni grasslands region, where the Sahjeevan Trust works*

2. *A group of women associated with the Deccan Development Society,Telangana*

3. *SCOPE supports community fisheries near Kolkata*

4. *Malkha works with weavers and cotton-growers in Telangana*

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For centuries, livestock herding communities have coexisted with wildlife in the Banni grasslands there, expertly breeding buffaloes and camels best suited to the terrain. However, government restrictions, encroachment and invasive plants have decimated the pastures. The Maldharis' distinctive way of life is in peril. Sahjeevan helps villagers regain and restore the grasslands and maintain local livestock breeds. Like DDS and Timbaktu, Sahjeevan believes people have the knowledge and ability to find lasting solutions. All they need is a helping hand.

East of Kolkata, **SCOPE** helps farmers and fisherfolk who sustain a remarkable system that biodegrades sewage from the city to produce paddy, vegetables, and fish. Villagers channel Kolkata's liquid waste into shallow ponds where they use the nutrient-rich water to grow food. SCOPE has set up this ingenious sewage treatment-cum-food production system in the Hooghly saltwater marshes and prevented them from being swallowed up by urban encroachment.

It is often forgotten that India's villages produce not only food but all manners of artisanal goods. An economy of skilled crafts that sustained millions was destroyed by colonialism. By hand-spinning cotton yarn and wearing khadi, Gandhi reminded us that defending this economy was an intrinsic part of our freedom. For **Malkha** in Hyderabad, recreating khadi today has meant not only supporting the weavers of hand-spun, handwoven cloth, but working with farmers to bring back local cotton varieties that were more suited to khadi. By tying these threads together, they have strengthened not only khadi but a larger ecosystem of sustainable production and consumption. **Bindaas Unlimited** in Kaladera, Rajasthan, has applied the same principles to revive natural dyeing, widening their market by crafting witty prints that are an affordable alternative to mass, throwaway fashion.

Besides *roti* and *kapda*, we need so much more to survive. Good health is essential. Often, the foremost reason why people sink into poverty is a medical crisis that entails catastrophic